CASE STUDY

A real-time sync between two Salesforce orgs

Every new opportunity and its related records, copied across the moment it is created, with each record matched, cleaned and de-duplicated on the way.

7
chained stages

136
steps in total

13
defects found in the follow-up audit

The problem

A global software company ran two Salesforce orgs with different data models, picklists, record types and ownership. A deal created in one org had to appear in the other, along with its account, contacts, partner contacts and campaign. A straight copy would have broken on every mismatch, so each record needed to be looked up, translated and matched first.

What I built

An event-driven pipeline in Zapier with JavaScript, split into seven stages. Each stage finds a record first, then updates or creates it, and hands its result to the next.

Stage	What it does
1. Trigger	Fires on a new deal, waits five minutes so the related records finish saving, then runs the other six stages in order.
2. Account	Fits the name to a downstream length limit, maps region with a currency fallback, bands company size, then finds, updates or creates the account.
3. Contact	Picks the best contact through a three-tier fallback, matches by email and creates if missing.
4 and 5. Partner contacts	Primary and secondary partner contacts, with early exits for deals that do not need them.
6. Campaign	Skips blank values, translates the campaign type between the two systems and links the contact.

7. Opportunity	The largest stage: maps record types, decides new business or upsell from deal history, applies partner rules, guards against duplicates, logs problems to a sheet and creates the deal with its contact roles.

The hard parts

- **Timing.** The source org writes related records after the deal. A deliberate wait stops later stages from searching for records that do not exist yet.
- **Missing and messy data.** Blank fields, unmapped picklist values and odd names are handled with fallbacks, or left blank on purpose, never guessed.
- **Rules with exceptions.** Partner-sourced deals follow one path, but specific campaigns override that rule. Both are encoded and documented.
- **No silent failures.** Duplicates and problems are written to an error log instead of disappearing.

The follow-up audit

I checked the integration's documentation against all seven live pipeline exports. About ten mapping rows were wrong, one object was missing from the documentation entirely, and four live fields were undocumented. I catalogued 13 numbered defects, including data that never reached the target system, and wrote up a corrected version of the mapping document.

The n8n version

After the Zapier build, I rebuilt the same architecture in n8n. The production system and its data are confidential, so the n8n workflow shows the architecture with sample records, not live data.

Tools

Salesforce (two orgs), Zapier (chained sub-zaps), JavaScript code steps, SOQL, Excel for the error log, n8n (architecture rebuild).

Details are generalised to protect the client.